“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Madhya-līlā

Chapter 13

The Dance before the Chariot

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

1 May Kṛṣṇa Caitanya be victorious, who danced before the holy chariot! His dance filled the world with wonder, and even Jagannātha was astonished.[1]

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra, and glory to all the devotees of Gaura![2]

3 Glory to you, my listeners! Hear with undivided attention of the Lord’s supremely enchanting dance at the Ratha-yātrā.[3]

4 The next day Mahāprabhu was on the watch: He rose while it was still night and bathed with His companions before dawn.

5 They went to see the *Pāṇḍu-vijaya*, as Jagannātha left His throne and set out on His journey.[4]

6 King Pratāparudra himself, with his officers, arranged for Mahāprabhu’s companions to see the procession.[5]

7 With Advaita, Nitāi and the other devotees, Mahāprabhu joyfully watched the Lord set out.

8 The powerful *dayitās*, like maddened elephants, carried Jagannātha forward, passing Him from hand to hand.[6]

9 Some *dayitās* supported His shoulders, and others held His holy lotus feet.

10 A strong, thick silk rope was tied around His waist, and holding it from both sides the *dayitās* lifted Him.

11 Thick, firm cushions of cotton were laid down one after another, and they quickly moved Him from one cushion to the next.

12 Under the tread of the Lord's feet the cushions burst apart; the cotton flew everywhere, and the noise was tremendous.[7]

13 Who can move Jagannātha, the sustainer of the universe? He moves by His own will, to enjoy His pastimes.

14 Mahāprabhu called out, "*Maṇimā*! *Maṇimā*!", but in the din of so many instruments nothing could be heard.[8]

15 Then Pratāparudra served in person: taking a golden broom, he swept the road.[9]

16 He sprinkled the road with sandalwood water: he who sat on the royal throne did this menial service.

17 Exalted as he was, the king stooped to this humble service, and therefore he became a vessel of Jagannātha's mercy.[10]

18 Mahāprabhu was happy to see this service, and through it the king won His mercy.

19 The people marvelled at the decoration of the chariot. It was new and golden, towering like Mount Sumeru.

20–21 Hundreds upon hundreds of fine *cāmaras* and mirrors made it shine. Above, a flag flew and a spotless canopy gleamed. Cymbals and little bells jingled, and the large bells rang. The chariot was adorned with many painted silk cloths.[11]

22 In His play the Lord mounted the chariot, and Subhadrā and Haladhara mounted the other two.

23 For fifteen days the Lord had stayed in seclusion with Mahā-Lakṣmī, enjoying His pastimes with her.[12]

24 Now, with her consent, He mounted the chariot and went out to enjoy His pastimes and give joy to His devotees.[13]

25 The road was covered with fine white sand like the bank of a river, and the gardens on both sides were like Vṛndāvana.[14]

26 Riding on His chariot, Jagannātha went along, looking at both sides with a joyful heart.

27 The *gauḍas* pulled the chariot joyfully. At times it moved fast, at times slowly.[15]

28 At times it stood still and would not move, however they pulled. It moved by the Lord’s will, not by anyone’s strength.

29 Then Mahāprabhu gathered all the devotees and with His own hand adorned each of them with garlands and sandalwood paste.

30 Paramānanda Purī and Brahmānanda Bhāratī received sandalwood paste from His holy hand, and their joy grew.[16]

31 Advaita Ācārya and Nityānanda Prabhu also rejoiced at the touch of His holy hand.

32 He gave garlands and sandalwood paste to the kīrtana singers, the chief of whom were Svarūpa and Śrīvāsa.

33 There were twenty-four singers in four groups, and eight more men played the mṛdaṅgas, two in each group.

34 Then, after thinking it over, Mahāprabhu divided the singers into four groups.[17]

35 He ordered four devotees — Nityānanda, Advaita, Haridāsa and Vakreśvara — to dance.

36 In the first group He made Svarūpa the leader and gave him five others to sing the responses:

37 Dāmodara, Nārāyaṇa, Govinda Datta, Rāghava Paṇḍita and Śrī Govindānanda.[18]

38 He ordered Advaita to dance there. Then He formed another group with Śrīvāsa as the leader:

39 Gaṅgādāsa, Haridāsa, Śrīmān, Śubhānanda and Śrī Rāma Paṇḍita; and Nityānanda danced there.[19]

40 He formed another group with Mukunda as the leader, in which Vāsudeva, Gopīnātha and Murāri sang,

41 with two more, Śrīkānta and Vallabha Sena; and Haridāsa Ṭhākura danced there.

42 He formed another group with Govinda Ghoṣa as the leader, in which Haridāsa, Viṣṇudāsa and Rāghava sang,[20]

43 with the two brothers Mādhava and Vāsudeva Ghoṣa; and Vakreśvara Paṇḍita danced there.

44 There was also a kīrtana party from Kulīna-grāma, in which Rāmānanda and Satyarāja danced.[21]

45 The Ācārya of Śāntipura had His own group as well: Acyutānanda danced there, and all the others sang.[22]

46 The group from Khaṇḍa held its kīrtana in another place; Narahari and Śrī Raghunandana danced there.[23]

47 Four groups sang in front of Jagannātha, one on either side, and one behind.

48 In the seven groups fourteen drums were played, and their sound drove the Vaiṣṇavas mad.

49 The Vaiṣṇavas were like massed clouds, and a downpour began: in the bliss of kīrtana they all rained tears.

50 The sound of the kīrtana rose and filled the three worlds; no other sound of instruments could be heard at all.

51 The Lord went about among the seven groups, calling “Hari! Hari!” Raising both arms, He cried, “Glory to Jagannātha!”

52 Then the Lord manifested another power: He enjoyed His pastimes in all seven places at once.[24]

53 Everyone said, “The Lord is in my group. Out of mercy to me He goes nowhere else.”

54 No one could perceive the Lord’s inconceivable power; only His intimate devotees, whose devotion is pure, knew it.

55 Jagannātha was delighted to see the kīrtana; He stopped His chariot and watched the saṅkīrtana.

56 Pratāparudra was filled with wonder; as he watched, he was overcome with prema.[25]

57 The king spoke to Kāśī Miśra of the Lord’s glory, and Kāśī Miśra said, “There is no limit to your good fortune.”

58 The king and Sārvabhauma silently exchanged knowing signs; no one else knew Caitanya’s secret.[26]

59 Only one who has His mercy can know it; without His mercy even Brahmā and the other gods cannot.

60 Seeing the king’s menial service, the Lord was pleased at heart, and by that very grace the king was granted a vision of this secret.[27]

61 He would not meet the king in person, yet He showed him mercy from afar. Who can understand the mysterious ways of Caitanyacandra?[28]

62 Seeing the grace shown to the king, the two great souls Sārvabhauma and Kāśī Miśra were astonished.

63 In this way the Lord enjoyed His pastimes for some time. He Himself sang and made His own devotees dance.

64 Sometimes He was in one form, sometimes in many: the Lord manifested His power according to the work at hand.

65 Absorbed in His pastimes, the Lord had no awareness of Himself; knowing His desire, His *līlā-śakti* arranged everything.[29]

66 Just as He once enjoyed the *rāsa* and other pastimes in Vṛndāvana, so now, moment after moment, Gaura revealed pastimes beyond this world.

67 The devotees experience them; no one else knows them. The *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* bears witness to this.[30]

68 Thus Mahāprabhu danced in joy and flooded everyone with waves of prema.[31]

69 So Kṛṣṇa mounted the chariot, and before it the Lord made His devotees dance.

70 Now hear of Jagannātha's journey to Guṇḍicā, and how the Lord danced before His chariot.

71 In this way the Lord led the kīrtana for some time and, by His own effort, made the devotees dance.

72 When the Lord wished to dance Himself, He brought the seven groups together in one place.

73–74 For His wild, leaping dance He put nine devotees together with Svarūpa: Śrīvāsa, Rāmāi, Raghu, Govinda, Mukunda, Haridāsa,

Govindānanda, Mādhava and Govinda.

75 These ten sang with the Lord and ran along with Him, and all the other groups sang on every side.

76 The Lord bowed down, joined His palms and, with His face lifted towards Jagannātha, offered prayers:

77 "I offer My obeisances to Kṛṣṇa, the Lord worshipped by the brāhmaṇas, the well-wisher of cows and brāhmaṇas and the benefactor of the whole world. Again and again I bow to Govinda." (Viṣṇu Purāṇa, 1.19.65)

78 "Glory, glory to the Lord, the son of Devakī! Glory, glory to Kṛṣṇa, the lamp of the Vṛṣṇi dynasty! Glory, glory to Him whose tender form is dark like a raincloud! Glory, glory to Mukunda, who removes the burden of the earth!" (Mukunda-mālā, 3)[32]

79 "Glory to Him, the refuge of all people, who is known as the son of Devakī! Attended by the best of the Yadus, with His own arms He casts out irreligion. He destroys the misfortune of all beings, moving and unmoving, and with His beautiful smiling face He makes love for Him grow ever stronger in the women of Vraja." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.90.48)[33]

80 "I am not a brāhmaṇa, not a king, not a vaiśya or a śūdra; I am not a brahmacārī, not a householder, not a vānaprastha or a sannyāsī. I am the servant of the servant of the servant at the lotus feet of the Lord of the gopīs, that radiant ocean of nectar brimming with all supreme bliss." (Padyāvalī, 74)[34]

81 After reciting these verses He bowed down again, and the devotees, with joined palms, offered prayers to the Lord.

82 The Lord danced His wild, leaping dance with loud roars. He whirled round and round like the ring of fire traced by a whirling firebrand.[35]

83 Wherever the soles of His feet struck the ground in the dance, the earth with its seas and mountains trembled.

84 Stupor, perspiration, hair standing on end, tears, trembling and pallor appeared in Him; overwhelmed by many feelings, He showed pride, joy and humility.

85 He fell heavily to the ground and rolled there like a golden mountain.

86 Nityānanda Prabhu, both arms outstretched, ran here and there, trying to catch the Lord.

87 Advaita Ācārya followed behind the Lord with loud roars, crying again and again, “Haribol! Haribol!”

88 Three circles were formed to hold back the crowd. In the first stood mighty Nityānanda.[36]

89 Kāśīśvara, Mukunda and all the other devotees joined hands and formed the second ring.

90 Outside them, Pratāparudra and his officers formed a circle and held back the crowd.

91 Resting his hand on Haricandana’s shoulder, the king watched the Lord’s dance, completely absorbed.

92 Meanwhile Śrīnivāsa, his heart absorbed in prema, stood in front of the king, watching the Lord dance.

93 Haricandana saw Śrīnivāsa in front of the king. He touched him with his hand and said, “Move aside.”

94 Absorbed in the dance, Śrīnivāsa was aware of nothing. Haricandana pushed him again and again, and Śrīnivāsa grew angry.

95 Śrīnivāsa stopped him with a slap, and Haricandana flared up in anger.[37]

96 In his anger Haricandana was about to say something to him, but Pratāparudra himself stopped him:

97 “You are fortunate: you have received the touch of his hand! Such fortune was not mine, but your life is now fulfilled.”[38]

98 Everyone who saw the Lord’s dance was amazed, and even Jagannātha’s bliss knew no bounds.

99 He stopped the chariot and would not go forward; with unblinking eyes He watched the dance.

100 Subhadrā and Balarāma rejoiced at heart; seeing the dance, the two of them smiled.

101 In the Lord’s wild, leaping dance wonderful transformations appeared: all eight *sāttvika* ecstasies arose in Him at once.

102 The hairs of His body stood erect on pores swollen like boils, and He looked like a *śimula* tree covered with thorns.

103 His teeth chattered so violently that people were frightened to see it; they thought all His teeth would fall out.

104 Perspiration poured from His whole body, and blood oozed out with it. His voice faltered: “Jaja gaga, jaja gaga.”[39]

105 Tears streamed from His eyes like jets from a fountain, and everyone around Him was drenched.

106 The golden lustre of His body turned rosy, and at times it seemed white, like a *mallikā* flower.

107 Sometimes He stood stunned, and sometimes He rolled on the ground; His hands and feet, stiff as dry wood, would not move.

108 Sometimes He fell to the ground, and sometimes His breathing stopped. Seeing this, the devotees felt their own life ebbing away.

109 Sometimes water flowed from His eyes and nose and foam fell from His mouth, as if streams of nectar were flowing over the disc of the moon.

110 Śubhānanda took that foam and drank it. He knew the taste of love for Kṛṣṇa, and great indeed was his good fortune!

111 Thus the Lord danced the vigorous *tāṇḍava* dance for some time, and then His mind entered a particular mood.

112 Leaving the *tāṇḍava* dance, He told Svarūpa to sing, and Svarūpa, who knew His heart, began to sing:

113 “I have found that very Lord of My life for whom I was wasting away, burning in the fire of Madana (love).”[40]

114 Svarūpa Dāmodara sang this refrain in a loud voice, and the Lord, in bliss, danced a sweet dance.

115 Jagannātha moved forward slowly, slowly, and the son of Śacī went ahead of Him, dancing.

116 With their eyes fixed on Jagannātha, everyone danced and sang, while the Lord and the kīrtana singers moved backwards, step by step.[41]

117 The Lord's eyes and heart were absorbed in Jagannātha, and with His two holy hands He acted out the song.

118 When Gaura drew back, Śyāma stood still; when Gaura went ahead, Śyāma moved on, slowly, slowly.[42]

119 Thus Gaura and Śyāma vied with each other, and mighty Gaura kept Śyāma waiting on His chariot.[43]

120 As He danced, the Lord's mood changed. Raising His arms, He recited a verse in a loud voice:

121 "He who stole My heart in My girlhood is now My lord. These are the same moonlit nights of Caitra, and the same full breezes blow from the kadamba groves, fragrant with blossoming *mālatī*. I too am the same. Yet My heart yearns for Our play of love there, beneath the *vetasī* trees on the bank of the Revā." (Padyāvalī, 386)[44]

122 Mahāprabhu recited this verse again and again, and no one but Svarūpa knew its meaning.

123 I have explained the meaning of this verse before; now I will briefly tell its inner sense.

124 Once, at Kurukṣetra, all the gopīs rejoiced at heart to see Kṛṣṇa.

125 When the Lord saw Jagannātha, that same mood arose in Him, and, absorbed in it, He had the refrain sung.

126 At last Rādhā made Her appeal to Kṛṣṇa: “You are the same, I am the same, and Our union is as fresh as before.

127 Yet Vṛndāvana steals My heart. Make Your feet appear in Vṛndāvana once again.

128 Here there is a forest of people, elephants and horses and the rumble of chariots; there, a forest of flowers, where I heard the humming of bees and the call of the cuckoos.

129 Here You wear royal dress and are surrounded by kṣatriya warriors; there You wore the dress of a cowherd boy, and with You was only the song of Your flute.

130 Of that ocean of happiness I tasted with You in Vraja, not one drop is here.

131 Take Me with You and play with Me again in Vṛndāvana. Only then will My heart’s desire be fulfilled.”

132 These words of Rādhikā from the *Bhāgavatam* I have already given earlier, in the summary of the pastimes.

133 Absorbed in that mood, the Lord recited another verse, but no one understood the meaning of such verses.

134 Svarūpa Gosāñi knew it but told no one; Śrī Rūpa Gosāñi made that meaning known.

135 In the midst of the dance He recited the verse whose meaning He always relished with Svarūpa:

136 (The gopīs said:) “O Lord whose navel is like a lotus, the masters of yoga, whose wisdom is fathomless, meditate within their hearts on Your lotus feet, the support by which souls fallen into the well of worldly life are lifted out. May those feet always rise in our minds too, though we are busy with our homes.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.82.48)[45]

137 “For others the heart is the mind, but My mind is Vṛndāvana: I take *mana* (mind) and *vana* (forest) as one. If You make Your two feet appear there, I will count it Your full mercy.[46]

138 O Lord of My life, hear My plea, for it is true. Vraja is My home, and there I long to be with You; if I cannot have that, I cannot live.

139 Before through Uddhava, and now to My face, You have told Me that yoga and knowledge are the way. You are clever and merciful, and You know My heart: it is not fitting to speak to Me like this.[47]

140 I want to draw My mind away from You and fix it on worldly things, but however hard I try, I cannot draw it away. And You teach such a one to meditate! You kill her by making her a laughingstock; You do not consider what is fitting and what is not.

141 The gopīs are not masters of yoga, to find satisfaction in meditating on Your lotus feet. Your polished words hide duplicity (*kuṭināṭī*), and hearing them, the gopīs grow only angrier.[48]

142 Those who have no memory of their bodies — where is the well of worldly life for them? They do not want deliverance from it. In the waters

of the ocean of separation the *timiṅgila* of *kāma*, their longing for You, is swallowing them: carry the gopīs across that ocean![49]

143 Vṛndāvana, Govardhana, the bank of the Yamunā and the forest; the *rāsa* dance and the other pastimes in those groves; the people of Vraja — Your mother, father and friends: how could You forget them? This amazes Me most of all!

144 You are clever, gentle, virtuous, well-mannered, affectionate and compassionate; in You there is not even a shadow of fault. That Your mind no longer remembers the people of Vraja is only the play of My ill fortune.

145 I do not count My own sorrow; but seeing the face of the queen of Vraja, the people of Vraja are heartbroken. Either kill them, or come to Vraja and bring them back to life. Why do You keep them alive only to suffer?[50]

146 Your strange dress, Your strange companions and Your strange land never please the people of Vraja. They cannot leave the land of Vraja, yet without seeing You they die. What will become of them?

147 You are the life of Vraja, the precious life of Vraja's king, and all the wealth of Vraja. Your heart is soft with mercy: come and revive the people of Vraja, and make Your feet appear in Vraja once again."

148 When Kṛṣṇa heard Rādhikā's words, the love of Vraja came to His mind, and His body and mind were shaken with feeling. Hearing of the love of Vraja's people, He felt Himself their debtor and began to console Her:

149 "My beloved, dear to Me as My life, hear these true words of Mine. Remembering all of you, I weep night and day, and no one knows My sorrow.

150 All the people of Vraja — My mother, My father and My friends — are as dear to Me as life. Among them the gopīs are My very life, and You are the life of My life.

151 The rasa of your love has made Me subject to you all; I am yours alone. It is a powerful ill fortune that has torn Me away from you, taken Me to a distant land and kept Me there.

152 She who loves cannot live without her beloved, nor he who loves without his beloved — this is proven truth. Yet each fears that the other, hearing of it, would come to the same end; and for this fear both keep themselves alive.

153 A loving, faithful wife and a loving husband who in separation wish only for each other's good, who do not count their own sorrow and want only the beloved's happiness — such a pair soon meet again.

154 To keep You alive I worship Nārāyaṇa, and by His power I come to You every day. After playing with You I go back to Yadupurī, and You take this to be only a vision of Me (*sphūrti*).[51]

155 My good fortune is the love You have for Me. That love is supremely powerful: it brings Me to You secretly and unites Me with You, and soon it will bring Me openly too.

156 I have destroyed all the wicked enemies of the Yādavas, the whole party of Kaṁsa. Only a few remain; when I have killed them, I will come to Vṛndāvana — know this for certain.

157 To protect the people of Vraja from those enemies I remain in My kingdom, but indifferent to it. And though I surround Myself with wives, sons and wealth, that is only the outward covering of a king's life, kept up to please the Yadus.[52]

158 The quality of Your love draws Me, and it will bring Me back within ten or twenty days. Then, coming again to Vṛndāvana, I will delight in pastimes night and day with You and the other maidens of Vraja."

159 Having said all this to Her, Kṛṣṇa, eager to go to Vraja, recited a verse for Her to hear. When Rādhā heard it, all Her doubts were dispelled, and She felt sure that She would attain Kṛṣṇa.

160 "Devotion to Me brings living beings to immortality. And how fortunate you are to have the love that brings you to Me!" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.82.44)[53]

161 Night and day the Lord would sit in His room with Svarūpa and relish all these meanings.

162 At the time of the dance, absorbed in that mood, He recited the verse and danced, gazing at Jagannātha's face.

163 The good fortune of Svarūpa Gosāñi cannot be described, for his body, words and mind were absorbed in the Lord.

164 The Lord's own senses entered Svarūpa's senses, and through them He relished the song.

165 Sometimes, overwhelmed by feeling, He would sit on the ground with His face lowered and write on the ground with His forefinger.

166 Fearing that the finger would be hurt, Dāmodara anxiously stopped the Lord's hand with his own.

167 Svarūpa's singing always matched the Lord's mood: whatever rasa the Lord felt at the moment, his song brought it to life.

168–169 The Lord gazed at the lotus face of Śrī Jagannātha with its two beautiful eyes, His face glittering in the rays of the sun, and at His garlands, His clothes, His divine ornaments and His fragrance.

170 An ocean of bliss surged in the Lord's heart, and at once divine madness rose like a storm wind.

171 In that madness of bliss waves of feeling rose, and the armies of His many feelings joined in the sport of battle.

172 Feelings arose and subsided, met and mingled; the transitory feelings, the *sāttvika* ecstasies and the abiding mood showed all their natural strength.[54]

173 The Lord's body was like a mountain of pure gold, and on it all the trees of feeling burst into blossom.

174 The sight of Him attracted everyone's heart and mind, and the Lord sprinkled every mind with a shower of the nectar of love.

175 All the servants of Jagannātha, the royal officers, the pilgrims and all the residents of Nīlācala

176 were astonished to see the Lord's dance and His love, and love for Kṛṣṇa awoke in everyone's heart.

177 Filled with love, the people danced and sang and raised a joyful uproar. At the Lord's dance the auspicious cries of the pilgrims grew four times as loud.[55]

178 Even Jagannātha and Haladhara (Balarāma), let alone the others, moved on slowly in delight as They watched the Lord's dance.

179 Sometimes They stopped Their chariots and joyfully watched the play of His dance. Whoever saw that wonder is its witness.

180 Dancing and whirling about in this way, the Lord was about to fall in front of Pratāparudra.[56]

181 Pratāparudra respectfully caught hold of the Lord, and on seeing him the Lord came back to outer consciousness.

182 Seeing the king, Mahāprabhu reproached Himself: “Fie, fie! I have been touched by a worldly man!”[57]

183 Nityānanda, lost in ecstasy, had not been watching, and Kāśīśvara, Govinda and the others were elsewhere.

184 Although the Lord had been pleased to see the king serving as a sweeper, and in His heart wished to meet him,

185 still, to make His own people careful, He outwardly showed a semblance of anger.[58]

186 The Lord’s words frightened the king, but Sārvabhauma said, “Do not worry.

187 The Lord is very pleased with you. He is only making you an example in order to teach His own people.

188 When I see the right moment, I will present your request, and then you can go and meet the Lord.”

189 Then Mahāprabhu walked around the chariot, went behind it, and pushed it with His head.

190 The moment He pushed, the chariot rolled on with a rumbling “haḍa-haḍa”, and all around the people cried, “Hari! Hari!”

191 Then the Lord, with His devotees, joyfully danced before Baladeva and Subhadrā.

192 After dancing there, He came back in front of Jagannātha and began to dance before Him.

193 Rolling on, the chariot reached Balagaṇḍi. There Jagannātha stopped His chariot and looked to the right and to the left.[59]

194 On the left was the brāhmaṇa settlement (*vipra-śāsana*) with its coconut grove; on the right was a flower garden like Vṛndāvana.[60]

195 In front, Gaura danced with His devotees, and Jagannātha, having stopped His chariot, watched Him.

196 By custom, food is offered to Jagannātha at that place, and He tastes millions of offerings.[61]

197 All of Jagannātha’s devotees, humble and great, offered Him the best food they had.

198 The king, the queens, the ministers and friends, all the residents of Nīlācala, humble and great,

199 and all the pilgrims from many lands offered their own food there.

200 In front and behind, on both sides, in the groves of the gardens, each offered his food wherever he found a place; there was no fixed rule.

201 At the time of the offering a great crowd gathered, so Mahāprabhu stopped dancing and went into a garden.[62]

202 Absorbed in love, Mahāprabhu entered the flower garden and lay down there on the raised platform (*piṇḍā*) of a house.

203 After the exertion of the dance His body was covered with sweat, and He enjoyed the cool, fragrant breeze.

204 All the devotees and kīrtana singers came into the garden and rested under the trees.

205 Thus I have told of the Lord's great saṅkīrtana and how He danced before Jagannātha.

206 How the Lord danced in front of the chariot, Rūpa Gosāñi has described in his *Śrī Caitanyāṣṭaka*:

207 "Before the Lord of Nīlācala, who sits on His chariot on the great road, He dances, overwhelmed by the joy of a dance that throbs with abundant waves of love, while the Vaiṣṇavas around Him sing in delight. Will that Caitanya ever again come before my eyes?" (Stava-mālā, First Caitanyāṣṭaka, 7)[63]

208 Whoever hears this attains Śrī Caitanya, and loving devotion with firm faith awakens in him.

209 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.[64]

Notes

1. Heading in the edition: “Glory to Gaurahari, who danced wondrously before the chariot.” ↩
2. The same verse as Ādi 10.2; translation as there. ↩
3. Heading in the edition: “Drawing the hearts of the listeners.” ↩
4. *Anubhāṣya*: the *Pāṇḍu-vijaya*, or *pahāṇḍi*, is the Deity’s passage from the throne to the chariot. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the servants tie Jagannātha, Baladeva and Subhadrā with silk ropes, carry Them out of the temple and raise Them onto the chariots near the Siṁha-dvāra. ↩
5. Heading in the edition: “The king and his officers help [the Lord’s companions] to see the *pahāṇḍi*.” ↩
6. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the *dayitās* (from *dayita*, “beloved”) are a special class of Jagannātha’s servants. By birth they do not belong to the respected castes, but service to Jagannātha has brought them the honour of the higher *varṇas*. The *Kṣetra-māhātmya* calls them Śabaras: the Deity Nīla-mādhava, who later became Jagannātha, once dwelt among the Śabaras, and so they were given the right of intimate service. ↩
7. *Anubhāṣya*: “the Lord” here is Śrī Jagannātha. Heading in the edition: “The weight of Jagannātha.” ↩
8. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *maṇimā* is the respectful address used in Utkala for those worthy of worship and for the king. ↩
9. Heading in the edition: “The king himself serves as a sweeper.” ↩
10. Heading in the edition: “Seeing the king’s humble service, the Lord shows him mercy.” ↩
11. *Anubhāṣya*: *ghāghara* — cymbals (*jhāñjh*); *kiṅkiṇī* — little bells (*ghuṅghur*); *kvaṇita* — ringing. ↩
12. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: for half a month after the bathing festival (Snāna-yātrā) Śrī Jagannātha stays in seclusion; this time is called *anavasara*. Then, with Lakṣmī’s permission, He sets out on the chariot. ↩
13. *Anubhāṣya*: during *anavasara* Jagannātha enjoyed pastimes with Mahā-Lakṣmī in seclusion, keeping the proper majesty (*maryādā*); now, with her consent, He went out for free pastimes to please the devotees of the path of *anurāga*, who are devoted to Kṛṣṇa alone, and here the mood of lawful wedlock (*svakīyā*) recedes. ↩
14. *Anubhāṣya*: the sand was like that of the Yamunā’s bank, and the groves on both sides of the road were like those of Vṛndāvana. ↩
15. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the cowherds (*goālās*) of Utkala are called *gauḍas*. ↩
16. Heading in the edition: “First, honour to the elders.” ↩

17. The edition reads চারি সম্প্রদায়ে (locative: “among the four groups”); the Bengali text and transliteration are corrected accordingly (scan, p. 547). ↩
18. *Anubhāṣya*: Dāmodara is Dāmodara Paṇḍita. ↩
19. *Anubhāṣya*: this Haridāsa is perhaps the elder Haridāsa (the commentator adds a question mark). ↩
20. *Anubhāṣya*: this Haridāsa is perhaps the younger Haridāsa (with a question mark), as distinct from the Haridāsa of the second group (39). ↩
21. *Anubhāṣya*: this group went on the left side of the chariot. ↩
22. Acyutānanda is the son of Advaita Ācārya. *Anubhāṣya*: this group was made up of Advaita’s followers and went on the right side of the chariot. ↩
23. *Anubhāṣya*: the group from Khaṇḍa went behind the chariot. ↩
24. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: just as in the *rāsa* dance and at His wedding with the queens Śrī Kṛṣṇa manifested Himself at once in many forms (*prakāśa*), so Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, showing the same power, manifested Himself in every group. ↩
25. Heading in the edition: “Seeing this, the king is amazed.” ↩
26. In the original, *curi* (“theft”) — the Lord’s secret, stealthy pastime. Heading in the edition: “The king silently exchanges signs with Sārvabhauma.” ↩
27. *Anubhāṣya*: Jagannātha, amazed at Mahāprabhu’s dancing and singing, stopped His chariot, and Mahāprabhu delighted Jagannātha by dancing before Him. Though the seer and the seen are here one and the same Reality, this wondrous secret was revealed in the variety of the pastimes, and by Mahāprabhu’s mercy the king understood it, and understood too that the Lord’s presence in all seven groups at once was part of the same secret. ↩
28. *Anubhāṣya*: playing the role of an *ācārya*, the Lord openly showed aversion even to the word “king”, yet in secret He was so merciful to Pratāparudra that the king entered into the mystery of His intimate pastimes. The meaning of this play, in which the Lord acts both as Īśvara and as if He were a *jīva*, no one but His one-pointed devotees can understand. ↩
29. *Anubhāṣya*: the Lord was so absorbed in the bliss of dancing and singing that He seemed to have forgotten Himself completely; but as soon as He wished, His potency of will (*icchā-śakti*), a form of the *svarūpa-śakti*, manifested His *prakāśa* forms and so served her Lord. ↩
30. *Anubhāṣya*: the *Bhāgavatam* testifies that at the *rāsa* dance and at the wedding with the queens Kṛṣṇa appeared in many forms at once; so too Gaurasundara appeared in many forms before the seven kīrtana groups and before Pratāparudra. Only devotees are allowed to see His transcendental pastimes. ↩

31. Heading in the edition: “By His dance the Lord delivers the people.” ↩
32. Heading in the edition: the verse is quoted in the *Padyāvalī* (108) as the words of Mukundadeva. ↩
33. Heading in the edition: “Glory to the transcendental, ever-new Kāmadeva.” *Anubhāṣya*: *kāma-deva* here is transcendental loving desire, which He kindles with His beautiful smile; *deva* means “transcendental”: this *kāma* is His own self-luminous nature. The women of Vrajapura are the women of Vraja and of the cities (Mathurā and Dvārakā), full of *anurāga*. ↩
34. Heading in the edition: the verse was spoken by Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and is quoted in the *Padyāvalī* (74). *Anubhāṣya*: “I” here is the soul, the *jīva*, by its own nature; it identifies itself neither with a *varṇa* nor with an *āśrama*, but is established in service to the servants of the Vaiṣṇavas. ↩
35. *Anubhāṣya*: a burning coal whirled very fast looks like a solid ring of fire, though there is no ring; so Mahāprabhu, dancing wildly, was one, yet He was seen everywhere. ↩
36. *Anubhāṣya*: “mighty” (*mahā-bala*) — Śrī Baladeva. So that the crowd would not crush Mahāprabhu, He was surrounded by three rings: if the crowd broke the third, the second would protect the Lord, and after it the first. ↩
37. Heading in the edition: “[Śrīvāsa] slaps Haricandana, who becomes angry.” ↩
38. Heading in the edition: “Even an insult or a blow from a Vaiṣṇava is a sign of good fortune.” ↩
39. *Anubhāṣya*: “jaja gaga” — so indistinctly did the Lord’s words sound when He tried to say “Jagannātha”. ↩
40. The same song as Madhya 1.55; translation as there. Heading in the edition: “The song of Śrī Dāmodara Svarūpa.” *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: leaving the *tāṇḍava* dance, Mahāprabhu felt in His heart Śrī Rādhā’s mood at the meeting in Kurukṣetra, and after the long separation this song came to Him of itself. ↩
41. *pāche pāche yāya*, “goes back, back”: facing Jagannātha (116–117), the Lord moved backwards before the chariot; cf. 118 and the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* there. ↩
42. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: when Gauracandra, acting out the song, walked backwards, Jagannātha stood still; when Gaura went forward, Jagannātha slowly moved after Him. Heading in the edition: “In the Lord, enriched with Śrī Rādhā’s mood, there is more prema than in Kṛṣṇa.” ↩
43. *Anubhāṣya*: in Śrī Rādhā’s mood Mahāprabhu draws Jagannātha — Kṛṣṇa — from Nīlācala, the place of His pastimes of majesty, to Guṇḍicā, the land of His pastimes of sweetness. He falls back to dispel the doubt whether Kṛṣṇa is really going out of love for Śrī Rādhā and the other people of Vraja; Jagannātha,

understanding His mood, stops and waits, and when Gaura goes forward, follows Him, abashed. In this contest of feelings Mahāprabhu, enriched with Śrī Rādhā's mood — that is, His prema — proves the stronger. ↩

44. The same verse as Madhya 1.58; translation as there. The heading in the edition says that the verse is cited in the *Kāvya-prakāśa* (1.4), the *Sāhitya-darpaṇa* (ch. 1) and the *Padyāvalī* (382). ↩
45. The same verse as Madhya 1.81; translation as there. Heading in the edition: "The gopī longs to have Kṛṣṇa in her own home." The edition then marks the following song (137–158) as "its meaning, in a rāga". ↩
46. *Anubhāṣya*: a worldly person calls "mind" the heart that makes and unmakes resolves; but the heart that has given up the urge to enjoy and is devoted to Kṛṣṇa's service Rādhā knows as "Vṛndāvana", the place of Śrī Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa's pastimes. Heading in the edition: "Kṛṣṇa should appear only in Vṛndāvana — in the pure heart that longs to please His senses." ↩
47. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: My heart is full of prema, and there is no room in it for *jñāna-yoga*. *Anubhāṣya*: for Uddhava's mission see Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.47. ↩
48. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: to teach the gopī meditation is mere duplicity, and hearing it, her wounded pride (*abhimāna*) only grows. ↩
49. *Anubhāṣya*: worldly life (*saṁsāra*) is born of the memory of the body, of absorption in thoughts of it; the gopīs, like perfected great devotees, have no such memory. The *timiṅgila* is a huge sea monster that can swallow even the great fish *timi*. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the *kāma* that swallows them is the desire for Kṛṣṇa's service alone. ↩
50. Heading in the edition: "Telling of Yaśodā's grief, Rādhā tries to stir Kṛṣṇa's compassion; the people of Vraja would rather die than be separated from Him." The *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* reads the third line otherwise: "now You kill them by separation, now You revive them by Your company". ↩
51. Heading in the edition: "A device to console Śrī Rādhā." *Anubhāṣya*: Yadupurī — Dvārakā and Mathurā. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: by the power of Nārāyaṇa's all-pervading majesty (*vibhutva*) I come to Vraja every day. ↩
52. The edition reads রাজ্য-আবরণে, hyphenated ("the covering of a kingdom"; scan, p. 557); the Bengali text and transliteration are corrected accordingly. *Anubhāṣya*: *yebā* — "although". ↩
53. The same verse as Ādi 4.23 and Madhya 8.89; translation as there. The heading in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition gives the reference as Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.82.31; the standard numbering is 10.82.44. ↩

54. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *bhāvodaya*, *bhāva-śānti*, *sandhi* and *śābalya* are the rising, the subsiding, the meeting and the mingling of feelings. *Anubhāṣya*: see Madhya 2.63. ↩
55. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *cauguṇa-maṅgala* — auspicious sounds (*maṅgala-dhvani*) multiplied fourfold. Heading in the edition: “All raise a joyful clamour of love.” ↩
56. Heading in the edition: “As He dances, the Lord is about to fall before the king.” ↩
57. Heading in the edition: “In outer consciousness the Lord — the teacher of the people, the guru of the world, playing the part of an ācārya — reproaches Himself because the king has touched Him.” ↩
58. *Anubhāṣya*: “His own people” — devotees who play the part of those seeking to cross the ocean of worldly life: free from possessions, turned towards Bhagavān’s service, striving to rise to prema. ↩
59. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Balagaṇḍi is the place between Śraddhābālu and the temple of Ardhāsanī-devī. ↩
60. *Anubhāṣya*: in Utkala a brāhmaṇa settlement is called *vipra-śāsana*. ↩
61. The edition prints the number of this verse as 197, so that 197 occurs twice. ↩
62. Heading in the edition: “At the time of the offering a crowd gathers, and the Lord goes into a nearby garden to rest.” ↩
63. The refrain as in Ādi 3.65 and 4.51. Heading in the edition: “Words of Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī, from the *Stava-mālā*, the first hymn to Śrī Caitanyadeva, verse 7.” *Anubhāṣya*: Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī composed three *Śrī Caitanyāṣṭakas*; this is the seventh verse of the first. “Overwhelmed” (*vivaśa*) — exhausted by the joy of the dance, in which abundant waves of prema were reflected. ↩
64. The same colophon as Madhya 7.155; translation as there. ↩